

XP Service Pack

Q I have a Pentium III 1.14 GHz processor and 128 MB SDRAM. I tried installing Windows XP Service Pack 1 from the November Mindware CD. After it copied all the files, it gave a message that the CD key is not valid. If the key was not valid then Windows XP would not have installed in the first place. Why am I getting this error?

Meetesh Jain

Via e-mail

A Since the release of Windows XP, Microsoft noticed that the vast majority of illegitimate copies are using a small handful of leaked CD keys. In an effort to thwart these illegitimate users, Windows XP Service Pack 1 will not install on systems using these keys. Microsoft claims that legitimate licensed users of



XP Professional should be unaffected.

During the installation of Windows XP Professional, you are prompted to enter a 25 digit Windows XP Product Key, which XP uses to generate the system's product ID. Because of security concerns about piracy, Microsoft does not provide a tool that allows you to view the Product Key that was used to install the operating system. The Product ID can be found by right-clicking My Computer and choosing Properties. To determine eligibility for the update, Service Pack 1 compares the Product ID on the system against the list. Service Pack 1 for Windows XP will fail to install if either the XXXXX-640-0000356-23XXX or the XXXXX-640-2001765-23XXX range of Product IDs is found on your system.

Outlook Express will either send back a message saying that the e-mail has been read, or ask the user for confirmation to do so, depending on the settings. It may also be set to never send such notifications. Thus, it is possible for the recipient to not send you the receipt notification.

Autorun

Q How can I create an Autorun CD?

Prabhat

Via e-mail

A To create an Autorun CD, simply place a text file named autorun.inf in the root. The contents of this text file can have a lot of property and behaviour-defining parameters, but the ones you will use most are the following:

open=<program path and name>

icon=<icon path and name>

Each parameter must appear on a separate line. Also, ideally the path should be relative, since the CD-ROM drive letter would differ from PC to PC. Thus, if you want to launch a program named runcd.exe from the Autorun folder on a CD, the text would be **open=autorun\runcd.exe**.

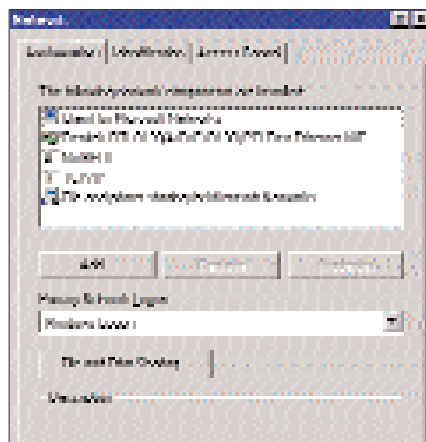
Cross cabling

Q I have an IBM NetVista with a D-Link Lan card installed. Recently I purchased a

Pentium 4 system with a Compex RE100ATX/WOL Lan card. I connected them with a cross-criped cable and after logging on, the IBM node was available in Network Neighborhood of the Pentium 4 system. When I tried accessing it, it displayed a message that the node was not accessible and the IBM system does not show Pentium 4 at all. On connecting the two via a hub on an existing network, both machines can access other systems on the network, but not each other. Please help.

Pathanjali Nadiminty

Via e-mail



Add, remove and configure protocols and services on Windows 9x

A You have not mentioned what operating systems each machine is running. The problem can occur due to incompatibility of network protocols across the machines, or simply some network settings. Ensure that the same set of protocols and services are installed on both systems and they should be able to communicate with each other. Also, if you are using only TCP/IP on both machines, make sure they both have valid IP addresses in the same subnet. You can configure all network settings by right-clicking Network Neighborhood and clicking Properties. Most importantly, ensure that File and Print Sharing is enabled on both computers.

Hindi on the Web

Q I would like to put a Word document containing Hindi script on the Internet. The document has been created on Windows 98 using Word 97, using Akruti fonts. The fonts have been embedded into the document and I tested it on several computers where Hindi fonts are not installed. The document opened properly, so I sent it to London, where the Web site is being maintained. The feedback from there is that they cannot see Hindi script as the font is not available. What could be the reason for this? Are there any limitations in embedding true type fonts in Word?

Prasad DVR

Via e-mail

A It is possible that the document is being viewed within Internet Explorer at the other end. Thus, the embedded fonts may not show. Also, it is possible that the document is being viewed on a different version of Microsoft Word, which may be handling the file differently. Create different versions of the document on different versions of Word and see if they open properly. Word 2000 and higher have stricter licensing policies when embedding fonts than Word 97, so this could cause the problem.

Startup screen

Q I'm facing a curious problem. Normally when Windows boots, it shows the graphical bootup screen of the Windows version. I have Windows 98 SE on my machine. For the last three months, my bootup screen has changed to that of Windows Memphis. I don't know how it got changed. I looked for the logos.sys and logow.sys files, but these are intact. The screen had changed after I installed some software. I have